

ROBERT SCHMITZ

INSTRUCTIONAL DESIGNER | LEARNING & DEVELOPMENT

Winter Haven, Florida

Open to remote

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SUMMARY

Instructional designer and doctoral student in Curriculum and Instruction (Instructional Design) at the University of Central Florida, with 10+ years building learning systems end to end: standards-to-objective curriculum maps, modular Canvas architecture, assessment item banks built as a reusable product, QTI packaging for LMS import, and facilitator-led training that puts the finished system in other instructors' hands. Designs for adult learners and secondary learners alike, and builds to the same spec in any content domain: analyze, write the objective, design the evidence, then build the instruction. Runs an AI-assisted, human-reviewed production workflow that turns standards documents into shipped, LMS-ready course packages.

10,000+ standards-aligned assessment items authored into reusable Canvas item banks · Canvas course package adopted district-wide and delivered by other instructors · 10+ years designing, delivering, and revising learning programs

EXPERIENCE

Founder / Instructional Designer | Real Engagement with Mathematics LLC | Concurrent with district role

Winter Haven, Florida. Designs and produces standards-aligned instructional systems and learning products end to end — analysis through packaged delivery — as instructional designer, subject-matter expert, and production lead.

- **Learning product design:** Builds curriculum maps, item banks, and print-ready practice systems from the standard down to the objective, each shipped with the facilitator materials an instructor needs to run it without the author in the room.
- **LMS packaging:** Packages assessment content as QTI for import into Canvas and Schoology, so a bank moves between platforms as one deliverable instead of being rebuilt by hand in each one.
- **Production workflow:** Runs a human-reviewed authoring pipeline in which AI assistants draft and screen large item banks at volume. Every item is checked against the objective it claims to measure before it ships.

Instructional Designer | Marion County Public Schools | 2019 – Present

Bellevue High School — the live lab. Designs the course system, delivers it to real learners, measures it, and rebuilds it on the evidence.

- **Learning system architecture:** Built and maintains the modular Canvas architecture behind multiple secondary content courses — sequenced modules, embedded assessment, study guides, and instructional video that carry a course asynchronously for learners working outside the session.
- **Assessment as a reusable product:** Authored 10,000+ items aligned to Florida B.E.S.T. standards and course objectives, organized into Canvas item banks that return instant feedback, generate on-demand practice, and produce the performance data the course is revised on.
- **Analysis and curriculum mapping:** Runs the analysis before anything is built, decomposing state standards into measurable objectives, learning progressions, and the performance evidence each one requires. The maps are the build spec the courses are made from.
- **Program design:** Designed and led exam-preparation programs for juniors and seniors targeting state assessments and college-readiness exams (ACT, SAT, CLT), built from diagnostic assessment, targeted remediation paths, and structured sessions against a defined graduation requirement.
- **Adoption and enablement:** Designs and facilitates the district in-service and virtual professional development that hands finished course packages to instructors who did not build them — curriculum design, standards implementation, Canvas course development. Onboards new instructors into curriculum development as Lead Teacher, and serves as Florida B.E.S.T. standards liaison.
- **Measurement and revision:** Reads state assessment results, district benchmarks, formative checks, and Canvas reporting to find the standards where the material is failing, then rebuilds it — measurably moving standards that had been underperforming. Department holds the county's highest learning gains in its content area; individual proficiency is the district's highest at the assigned course level.

Instructor & Curriculum Developer | Polk County Public Schools | 2017 – 2019

Jere L. Stambaugh Middle School. Middle-grades instructional materials and assessment, built and delivered through the LMS.

- Developed instructional materials, assessments, and intervention supports aligned to learner readiness levels and performance goals, delivered through LMS-based lessons, digital tools, and game-based applications.
- Used formative assessment and progress-monitoring data to revise those materials, working with instructional teams on school-wide improvement during a turnaround effort.

GED Instructor | Hillsborough County Public Schools | 2015 – 2016

Plant City High School. Adult learning design for a mixed-subject GED cohort working toward certification and workforce readiness.

- Designed learner-centered instruction for adult learners with widely varied prior knowledge, schooling history, and primary languages, then adapted materials and assessment strategy to accelerate readiness for high-stakes proficiency testing.
- Ran individualized progress monitoring across a mixed-subject adult cohort, targeting support to each learner's specific gap to improve persistence and achievement.

AI QUALIFICATIONS

Tools in production use — Claude, Codex, and Grok run as production assistants inside a human-reviewed instructional-design workflow, on the same curriculum and assessment work described above.

Where they are applied — Item-bank authoring and screening against the standard and objective each item claims to measure; aligned practice and feedback variants; first-draft curriculum maps built from standards documents; templated LMS modules so a new course starts from a working skeleton; and QTI 2.1 packaging for Canvas and Schoology import.

Quality control — Nothing ships on model output alone. Every item is reviewed against the learning objective, the answer key, and the standard before it reaches a learner, and anything that cannot be traced to a measurable objective is cut.

Academic grounding — Doctoral study in Curriculum and Instruction (Instructional Design) at the University of Central Florida, with applied focus on AI-assisted curriculum production.

DESIGN METHOD

Analysis and design — ADDIE and Dick & Carey applied to course builds: analyze audience and standards, write measurable objectives, design the assessment that proves them, then build the instruction that gets there. State assessment data, district benchmarks, formative checks, and LMS reporting drive revision of the materials themselves, not only of delivery.

Structure, access, and delivery — Gagné's Nine Events for sequencing within a module; UDL for multiple representations and multiple means of demonstrating mastery; learners moved from concrete interaction to representational analysis to abstract reasoning. Delivered as asynchronous self-paced LMS courses, blended instruction, instructional video and job-aid study guides, and facilitator-led training in person and virtually.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Four artifacts designed and built end to end, and in use.

Canvas course package — Standards-aligned modules, assessment pathways, item banks, and an integrated study guide built as a single package. Adopted district-wide and now delivered by other instructors as a ready-built state-assessment path.

Exam-preparation program, juniors and seniors — Diagnostic assessment, targeted remediation paths, and structured sessions for students working against a graduation concordance requirement on state assessments and the ACT, SAT, and CLT.

QTI assessment package — Item banks authored to the objective and tagged by standard, exported as QTI 2.1 so one source bank imports into either Canvas or Schoology and regenerates practice, quizzes, and retakes on demand.

District B.E.S.T. alignment and PD — Aligned curriculum and instructional materials to Florida B.E.S.T. standards with district stakeholders, then designed and delivered the professional development that put the alignment into practice.

TOOLS AND PLATFORMS

LMS and packaging — Canvas LMS (course architecture, modules, item banks, reporting) · Schoology · QTI 2.1 export and import

Authoring and media — Articulate Storyline 360 · storyboarding · instructional video (YouTube) · Adobe Photoshop · WordPress

Assessment and practice — Item banks · diagnostic and formative checks · Desmos Classroom, Blooket, and Gimkit for practice built on the same objectives as the graded assessments

Production — Microsoft 365 · Google Workspace · curriculum mapping · content curation · AI-assisted authoring (Claude, Codex, Grok)

EDUCATION AND CREDENTIALS

Education — Doctoral Student, Curriculum and Instruction (Instructional Design), University of Central Florida · M.Ed., Mathematics Education, University of Central Florida · B.S., Social Studies Education, University of South Florida

Credentials — Instructional Design Certification, University of Central Florida · Florida Professional Teaching Certificate: Mathematics 6–12, Middle Grades Integrated Curriculum, Social Studies 6–12